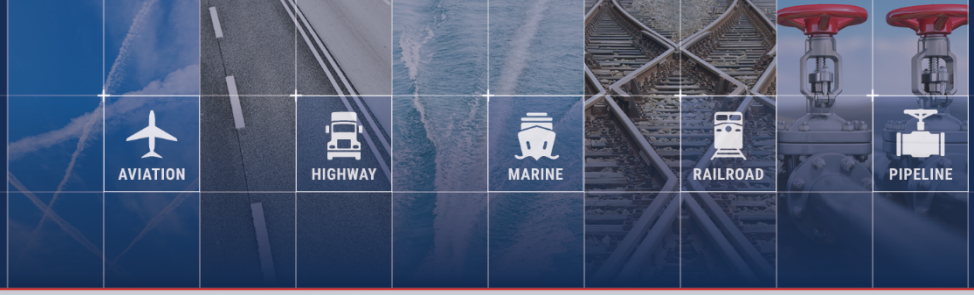

Aviation Investigation Final Report

Location:	Los Alamos, New Mexico	**Accident Number:**	WPR25LA076
Date & Time:	December 31, 2024, 13:15 Local	**Registration:**	N71074
Aircraft:	Cessna 182M	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Defining Event:	Loss of control on ground	**Injuries:**	1 None
Flight Conducted Under:	Part 91: General aviation - Personal		

Analysis

The pilot reported that while monitoring his destination airport's automated weather report during a local flight he discovered that the wind had was initially from 180° at 7 knots but had increased to 11 knots with gusts to 18 knots.

The pilot selected runway 27 for landing, and during final approach, encountered turbulence along with a fluctuation in airspeed of plus or minus 10 miles per hour, which he attributed to possible low-level wind shear. When about 50 ft above ground level, the pilot heard the stall warning horn while in a nose down attitude. The pilot stated that he focused on solely on airspeed and failed to maintain appropriate crosswind correction, as wind gusts pushed the airplane towards the left side of the runway. The pilot was unable to recover from the uncommanded movement and the airplane touched down on or near the left edge of the runway beyond the runway threshold. The airplane crossed the grassy area between the runway and taxiway, struck a taxiway curb and the nose landing gear collapsed, which resulted in substantial damage to the fuselage.

The pilot reported no preaccident mechanical malfunctions or failures with the airplane that would have precluded normal operation.

Probable Cause and Findings

The National Transportation Safety Board determines the probable cause(s) of this accident to be:

The pilot's failure to maintain airplane control while landing in gusty crosswind conditions.

Findings

Personnel issues	Decision making/judgment - Pilot
Environmental issues	Gusts - Effect on operation
Personnel issues	Aircraft control - Pilot

Factual Information

History of Flight

Landing-landing roll	Loss of control on ground (Defining event)

Pilot Information

Certificate:	Private	**Age:**	46,Male
Airplane Rating(s):	Single-engine land	**Seat Occupied:**	Left
Other Aircraft Rating(s):	None	**Restraint Used:**	3-point
Instrument Rating(s):	Airplane	**Second Pilot Present:**	No
Instructor Rating(s):	None	**Toxicology Performed:**	
Medical Certification:	Class 3 With waivers/limitations	**Last FAA Medical Exam:**	July 28, 2023
Occupational Pilot:	No	**Last Flight Review or Equivalent:**	February 15, 2024
Flight Time:	573 hours (Total, all aircraft), 398 hours (Total, this make and model), 521 hours (Pilot In Command, all aircraft), 4.5 hours (Last 90 days, all aircraft)		

Aircraft and Owner/Operator Information

Aircraft Make:	Cessna	**Registration:**	N71074
Model/Series:	182M	**Aircraft Category:**	Airplane
Year of Manufacture:	1968	**Amateur Built:**	
Airworthiness Certificate:	Normal	**Serial Number:**	18259484
Landing Gear Type:	Tricycle	**Seats:**	4
Date/Type of Last Inspection:	November 14, 2024 Annual	**Certified Max Gross Wt.:**	2800 lbs
Time Since Last Inspection:		**Engines:**	1 Reciprocating
Airframe Total Time:	942.1 Hrs at time of accident	**Engine Manufacturer:**	Continental
ELT:	Installed, activated, did not aid in locating accident	**Engine Model/Series:**	O-470-R
Registered Owner:	FRONT ROW LLC	**Rated Power:**	230
Operator:	On file	**Operating Certificate(s) Held:**	None
Operator Does Business As:	Partner, Front Row LLC	**Operator Designator Code:**	

Meteorological Information and Flight Plan

Conditions at Accident Site:	Visual (VMC)	**Condition of Light:**	Day
Observation Facility, Elevation:	KLAM,7171 ft msl	**Distance from Accident Site:**	1 Nautical Miles
Observation Time:	13:15 Local	**Direction from Accident Site:**	286°
Lowest Cloud Condition:	Clear	**Visibility**	8 miles
Lowest Ceiling:	None	**Visibility (RVR):**	
Wind Speed/Gusts:	11 knots / 17 knots	**Turbulence Type Forecast/Actual:**	/
Wind Direction:	170°	**Turbulence Severity Forecast/Actual:**	/
Altimeter Setting:	30.01 inches Hg	**Temperature/Dew Point:**	4°C / -10°C
Precipitation and Obscuration:	No Obscuration; No Precipitation		
Departure Point:	Taos, NM (SKX)	**Type of Flight Plan Filed:**	None
Destination:	Los Alamos, NM	**Type of Clearance:**	None
Departure Time:	11:30 Local	**Type of Airspace:**	Class G

Airport Information

Airport:	LOS ALAMOS LAM	**Runway Surface Type:**	Asphalt
Airport Elevation:	7170 ft msl	**Runway Surface Condition:**	Dry
Runway Used:	09/27	**IFR Approach:**	None
Runway Length/Width:	6000 ft / 120 ft	**VFR Approach/Landing:**	Straight-in;Traffic pattern

Wreckage and Impact Information

Crew Injuries:	1 None	**Aircraft Damage:**	Substantial
Passenger Injuries:	N/A	**Aircraft Fire:**	None
Ground Injuries:		**Aircraft Explosion:**	None
Total Injuries:	1 None	**Latitude, Longitude:**	35.879686,-106.26868

Administrative Information

Investigator In Charge (IIC):	Stein, Stephen
Additional Participating Persons:	Vernon Rockett; Federal Aviation Administration; Albuquerque, NM
Original Publish Date:	April 22, 2025
Last Revision Date:	
Investigation Class:	Class 4
Note:	The NTSB did not travel to the scene of this accident.
Investigation Docket:	https://data.ntsb.gov/Docket?ProjectID=199524

The National Transportation Safety Board (NTSB) is an independent federal agency charged by Congress with investigating every civil aviation accident in the United States and significant events in other modes of transportation—railroad, transit, highway, marine, pipeline, and commercial space. We determine the probable causes of the accidents and events we investigate, and issue safety recommendations aimed at preventing future occurrences. In addition, we conduct transportation safety research studies and offer information and other assistance to family members and survivors for each accident or event we investigate. We also serve as the appellate authority for enforcement actions involving aviation and mariner certificates issued by the Federal Aviation Administration (FAA) and US Coast Guard, and we adjudicate appeals of civil penalty actions taken by the FAA.

The NTSB does not assign fault or blame for an accident or incident; rather, as specified by NTSB regulation, "accident/incident investigations are fact-finding proceedings with no formal issues and no adverse parties … and are not conducted for the purpose of determining the rights or liabilities of any person" (Title 49 *Code of Federal Regulations* section 831.4). Assignment of fault or legal liability is not relevant to the NTSB's statutory mission to improve transportation safety by investigating accidents and incidents and issuing safety recommendations. In addition, statutory language prohibits the admission into evidence or use of any part of an NTSB report related to an accident in a civil action for damages resulting from a matter mentioned in the report (Title 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b)). A factual report that may be admissible under 49 *United States Code* section 1154(b) is available here.